

Sales Tracker:

The "Get.1a.Sales Tracker" model. By systematically recording and analyzing sales activities, pipeline velocity, and referral networks, this spreadsheet-based tracking system creates a transparent environment that benefits both the advisor and the business owner.

The material is of an entry level and suits new and experienced advisors alike, provided they are focused on fee growth.

Marketing:

This content is designed to help accountants transition from basic tax compliance to high-value consulting and is suitable for those looking to enhance client relationships, effectively frame their services as aspirational, and provide meaningful strategic oversight.

The content is primarily of a STRATEGIC and COMMUNICATION nature and therefore, serves as a turnkey system equipped with communication templates, predictive modeling, and legal safeguards to help advisors protect intellectual property, identify growth opportunities, and prevent financial "surprises".

The material is of an entry level and suits new and experienced advisors alike.

1st Response Email

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It provides clarity on the project methodology by using an "Agile Theory" metaphor, allowing them to understand the project's structural integrity and scope before committing to large final budgets.
- How it helps the advisor: It establishes a structured, phased engagement process (Feasibility, Planning, Implementation) and secures a clear initial feasibility fee of \$5,000 (+gst).
- Who it may be suitable for: Prospects or existing clients who have submitted a request for tender, project inquiry, or requested a meeting regarding a new project.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Receive a project inquiry or request for a tender from a prospective or existing client.
2. Send this email to introduce the "Agile Theory" project management philosophy, breaking the engagement down into three distinct stages.

3. Detail the "Feasibility" stage, explaining that it includes defining objectives, a SWOT review, loan assessments, volatility reports, and a '6-Hats' review.
4. State the engagement terms clearly, noting the \$5,000 (+gst) fee, the requirement of three meetings, and an expectation of about five hours of the client's own time.
5. Follow up via phone in the coming days to gather their feedback.

Common Q&A

- What project management philosophy is introduced in this email? The email introduces "Agile Theory," which requires a brief global perspective followed by successive work 'Sprints'.
- What are the three stages of the engagement process? The stages are Feasibility, Planning, and Implementation.
- What does the Implementation phase specifically review? It systematically reviews 6 critical business functions: Planning, Data/\$ Management, Marketing, Sales, People, and Process.
- Where is the engagement supported to maintain real-time involvement? The entire engagement is supported via a portal, which hosts vital meeting notes and tracks task progress.
- What is the initial fee and time commitment for the client? The fee is \$5,000 (+gst), requiring attendance at three meetings and roughly five hours of the client's time.

3rd Quarter Campaign.

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It protects them from the "perfect storm" of Provisional Tax, GST Tax, and holiday periods by prompting them to secure cash forecasts and review debt structures early.
- How it helps the advisor: It generates advisory engagements and business planning sessions by providing pre-written marketing emails, text messages, and video links.
- Who it may be suitable for: Business owners in industries prone to rushing to complete projects before the holiday "silly season," or those lacking structured business plans.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Create the client's business entity in the portal and pair the client details to the entity.
2. Import the client's cash volatility data and generate a cash volatility report.
3. Choose a marketing option based on the goal: "Bags of Cash" for cash forecasting or "Planning Ahead" for business planning.

4. Send the chosen email or SMS text message (which includes a 2-minute video link) to the client.
5. Call the client within 48 hours to follow up and gauge their interest in a review.

Common Q&A

- What are the two main focuses of the 3rd Quarter Campaign? Securing cash forecasts/working capital reviews and securing business planning sessions.
- How many template options are available within Advisor-e for planning sessions? There are 7 template options available within Advisor-e.
- What causes the financial "perfect storm" mentioned in the email? A combination of businesses rushing to complete projects and Provisional Tax and GST Tax falling in the middle of a holiday period.
- What is the purpose of the "Bags of Cash" video link? It helps the client better understand the need for a quick "Cash Volatility" review before people get into trouble.
- What consequence is suggested if a client lacks a business plan? The absence of a plan almost certainly guarantees missed opportunities and lower family income.

90 Day BP Acct

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It trains their financial administrators to avoid costly mistakes, uncovers tax deductibility issues at the source, and prevents surprise tax bills from the IRD.
- How it helps the advisor: It generates a fee of \$1,500 to \$1,800 (+gst) while eliminating the need for the advisor to spend hours cleaning up "birds-nest nightmares" in the client's financial software.
- Who it may be suitable for: Business owners utilizing software like Xero whose staff may be out of their depth, requiring structured, real-time training.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Send the 1st Outreach Email outlining the 90-day accounting best practice plan to the client.
2. Set up the payment terms: 3 monthly installments totaling \$1,500+gst (or \$1,800+gst for international traders).
3. Deliver the first 60-minute session via Zoom on "Coding & Reporting Platform" to review their chart of accounts.

4. Conduct subsequent Zoom sessions covering the "Transaction Platform", "Monthly Quality Control" (90 minutes), optional "Overseas Trading", and a final "90 Day Close Off".
5. Provide ongoing "spot question" phone support and access to "Quick Reminder" tutorial videos throughout the 90 days.

Common Q&A

- Why is the 90 Day Plan necessary if a client uses Xero? Because clients often get out of their depth, and it is wiser to train them initially than to spend hours unwinding transactions later.
- How is the training delivered? The training is delivered via Zoom so the advisor can watch staff complete tasks in real-time.
- What is covered in the Transaction Platform session? A deep dive into generating invoices, reconciling correctly, treating deposits, and multiple invoice bundling.
- What items are checked during the Monthly Quality Control session? Cancelled orders, deposit refunds, overpayments, and stock balances.
- What happens during the 90 Day Close Off session? The advisor demonstrates how to close off the preceding 90 days, make adjustments, and complete an interim stock take.

Bankers login email.

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It bridges the gap between their financial advisor and their bank, ensuring their banker can participate in a structured advisory service.
- How it helps the advisor: It securely onboards external centers of influence (bankers) into the software ecosystem and opens the door for new client referrals.
- Who it may be suitable for: Bankers or external advisors who are collaborating with the accountant on mutual clients.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Generate the 'External Advisor' registration link from the Advisor-e platform.
2. Send the template email to the banker, advising them that the email will come from Advisor-e.com rather than a personal address.
3. Instruct the banker to check their Junk or Spam folders if the registration link is not immediately visible.
4. Offer technical support via phone or email if they experience login hassles.

5. Use the post-script to solicit referrals, reminding the banker that referred clients do not need to cancel their existing accounting relationships for compliance.

Common Q&A

- What domain will the registration link be sent from? The registration link will show Advisor-e.com.
 - What is the banker instructed to do if they cannot find the email? Check their Junk or Spam folder, or contact the advisor for technical help.
 - What platform will the banker use to work with mutual clients? The Advisor-e software platform.
 - Can a banker refer a client who already has an accountant? Yes, the client does not need to cancel their existing accountant relationship; the current accountant can handle compliance while advisory services are added.
 - What is the main goal of the post-script in this email? To encourage the banker to refer banking clients who could benefit from structured advisory services.
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Covid Email & Phone

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It allows them to proactively estimate their financial position under 'Good, Bad & Ugly' scenarios and secure bank funding before credit divisions are overwhelmed.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a systematic, multi-channel approach (email, SMS, and specific phone scripts) to secure 'Covid Plan' meetings and demonstrate high value during a crisis.
- Who it may be suitable for: Business owners facing disruptions, cash flow blockages, lockdowns, or supply shortages.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Compile a target list of clients and import them into Advisor-e (via Xero or MYOB) to create client accounts and Volatility Reports.
2. Unlock the Covid Personal Budget and Covid Loan estimator models within each client's service plan.
3. Sign up for an SMS software (like textmagic.com) and send a text notification alerting the client to check their email.
4. Send one of the three designated Covid emails offering access to the portal templates or the 32 available revenue models.

5. Follow up using one of the provided phone scripts, asking the client to choose a focus area: Getting Organised, Getting the Job, or Doing the Job.

Common Q&A

- Why does the template urge applying for funding lines quickly? Because if left too late, cash flow gets tight and banks' credit divisions will be flooded and unable to cope with the volume.
 - What are the three scenarios the templates help estimate? Good, Bad & Ugly scenarios.
 - How many Revenue models are available to calculate the effects of changes? There are 32 Revenue models available.
 - What does "Getting Organised" mean in the context of the phone script? Having clear activity targets and being confident in the business Strategy.
 - Is there a charge for the initial Covid Contingency meeting? No, there is no charge for the initial session; it is framed as investing in the relationship.
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TCM.Quiz link email

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It requires minimal time (under 3 minutes) to help them focus their thoughts on what they need to work on over the next 90 days.
- How it helps the advisor: It acts as a rapid qualification and engagement tool that primes the prospect before offering further guidance.
- Who it may be suitable for: Prospects or clients who need help prioritizing their immediate business goals and are open to a brief digital assessment.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Discuss the quiz briefly with the business owner via a prior conversation.
2. Send the email or text template containing the quiz link.
3. Encourage the client to complete the survey on their smartphone.
4. Wait for the quiz results to be submitted under strict confidence.
5. Contact the business owner with targeted guidance based on their completed quiz results.

Common Q&A

- What is the core purpose of the quiz? To help the business owner get focused on what they need to work on in the next 90 days.
- How long should the quiz take to complete? Less than 3 minutes.

- Can the client complete the quiz on a mobile device? Yes, they can do it from their smartphone.
 - Are the quiz results shared publicly? No, all answers are treated in the strictest confidence.
 - What is the advisor's immediate action after sending the link? To wait for the completed results and then get in touch with further guidance.
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Cartoon Images

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It breaks down complex financial, operational, and growth concepts using simple, engaging visual metaphors.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides ready-to-use visual assets for presentations, simplifying the explanation of margin, working capital, and business lifecycles.
- Who it may be suitable for: Clients who are visual learners, or those struggling to grasp abstract business concepts like working capital or the growth curve.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Review the slide deck to identify the specific business concept you need to convey to your client.
2. Select the appropriate image (e.g., the circular "Money in Movement" graphic for cashflow discussions, or the "Profit Sweet-Spot" graphic for scale and debt).
3. Insert the chosen image into your presentation, portal documents, or discussion materials.
4. Use the imagery to guide the conversation (e.g., pointing out the stages of the growth curve from Design to Exit/Decline).
5. Leverage the metaphors (like airplanes, sharks, or a balanced seesaw) to gauge client understanding.

Common Q&A

- What are the four components of the "Money in Movement" working capital cycle? Cash, Stock, Sale, and Debtors.
- What does the "Profit Sweet-Spot" image warn against? It contrasts a small, profitable business with one that pursues bigger premises and more staff but struggles with debt to make the customer numbers profitable.

- What is shown on the steps of the Advisor-e staircase image? The steps list phases like Observation, Application, Interpretation, Assimilation, Spotlight, Compilation, Verification, and Xero.
 - What are the stages mapped out on the curved pipeline graphic? Design, Launch, Break even, Lifestyle, Leverage, Reach, Leapfrog, Maturity, Split Point, "Devil's Toilet", and Exit/Decline.
 - What visual is used to depict someone predicting future business outcomes? A cartoon of a man looking intensely into a crystal ball labeled "FUTURE".
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Invitation email

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It provides 24/7 access to a portal containing meeting agendas, action plans, and business improvement templates to help them solve problems and grow.
- How it helps the advisor: It creates a seamless onboarding process using varying tones (standard, conservative, or energetic) to get clients registered into the Advisor-e software.
- Who it may be suitable for: New or existing clients being introduced to the firm's cloud-based business improvement portal.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Select the tone most appropriate for the client: Standard, Conservative (framing it as a trial), or the "Mental Gym" metaphor.
2. Ensure the client knows to look for an email banner displaying Advisor-e.com and to check their spam/junk folders.
3. Instruct the client to click the blue 'Finish Signing Up' button and create a memorable password.
4. Direct them to click the Yellow Button ('Client Service Plan') once inside to view initial recommended content.
5. If they fail to register, send the "Following Up the Login Release" email to remind them to authenticate their login.

Common Q&A

- What does the portal allow the advisor and client to record? Meeting agendas and action plans, ensuring a record of what was talked about and who is supposed to do what.

- How is the "Conservative Approach" email framed to the client? It is framed as the accounting firm trialing a new way of delivering value-added services and asking for the client's feedback.
 - What metaphor is used in the third email option to describe the portal? It is described as a "mental gym" for motivated business owners.
 - What color is the button the client must click inside the portal to view starting content? The button for the Client Service Plan is Yellow.
 - What URL is provided as a video explanation in the post-scripts? <https://vimeo.com/user41313689/clientinvitation>.
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Messaging Plan

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It ensures that marketing and communications are directly tailored to solve their specific problems (like cashflow or teamwork) rather than being generic.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides a highly structured framework (C.P.D hierarchy and timeline) to align social media, articles, speeches, and seminars into a cohesive marketing engine.
- Who it may be suitable for: Advisory teams and marketing coordinators needing a step-by-step strategy for building campaigns, running seminars, and establishing concept domains.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Determine your Target Market problems and create "Concept Domains" based on your Fee Growth Plan.
2. Use the provided table to link Client Problems (e.g., Struggling with Money in Movement) to a Concept Domain (Cashflow) and an Offer (Growth Education Session).
3. Build the GLOBAL messaging plan using the C.P.D hierarchy: define a Concept, support it with 3 Principles, and break each down into 3 points of Detail.
4. Populate a Communication Plan matrix, mapping Concept Domains to specific Videos, Articles, Speeches, and Blogs.
5. Draft a Broad Timeline (spanning months like July to February) to sequence actions, account for holidays, and schedule rehearsals and seminars.

Common Q&A

- What does the acronym C.P.D stand for in the messaging plan? Concept, Principle, Detail.
- What is the first step in creating the messaging plan? Determine the Target Market Profile and identify their common problems.
- If a client struggles to make enough sales, what Concept Domain is suggested? "Winning Business".
- Why is it important to build a 'Broad' Timeline initially? To consider workflow and holidays, and to ensure the sequence of interrelated actions is correct from the outset.
- What should be included from the Fee Growth Plan to prompt marketing actions? 'Hustle Tactics'.

Mutual confidentiality

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner (Party B): It legally protects the information they disclose regarding their business and systems during the evaluation.
- How it helps the advisor (XYZ Ltd): It protects their intellectual property and service offers when determining the scope of works for a software application project.
- Who it may be suitable for: Two distinct corporate entities engaging in a software application evaluation requiring the sharing of sensitive data.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Insert the legal names of both parties (e.g., XYZ Accounting Ltd and Party B) at the top of the agreement.
2. Review the Background and Terms to ensure the definitions of "Evaluation" and "Confidential Information" fit the scope of the software project.
3. Understand that information can only be used for the evaluation, and cannot be copied, reproduced, or electronically stored if so stipulated in writing by the Discloser.
4. If compelled by law to disclose information, ensure immediate written notice is given to the other party.
5. Both Directors must sign and date the Execution section to bind the agreement.
6. Return or destroy all confidential information upon completion of the evaluation.

Common Q&A

- What is the stated purpose of Party B obtaining information from XYZ? To support their understanding of XYZ's service offer and determine the scope of works for a software application project.

- How does the agreement define a "Business Day"? A weekday on which institutions are open for general business in Hamilton, New Zealand.
 - Under what circumstances does the confidentiality undertaking not apply? Information in the public domain, information that becomes public, or information known to the party prior to disclosure.
 - What specific New Zealand Act is referenced regarding the secure keeping of information? The New Zealand Privacy Act 1993.
 - If a breach occurs, what remedies are acknowledged as appropriate? Orders for specific performance and injunctive relief.
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On-Line Quiz Summary

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It provides a quick, interactive way to reflect on their business fundamentals, technology usage, or HR practices without pressure.
- How it helps the advisor: It serves as a lead generation tool, qualifying prospects and acting as a "micro-step" between initial contact and a formal meeting.
- Who it may be suitable for: Both existing clients and new prospects who need priming before a sales or review meeting.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Select the appropriate quiz based on the prospect's industry or pain points (Growth Fundamentals, What's Applicable, or HR Maths).
2. Copy the respective Google Forms link provided in the slide deck.
3. Send the link to the prospect to act as a 'micro-step' before meeting for the first time.
4. Review the incoming responses to determine their receptivity towards specific software, data reviews, or HR efficiencies.
5. Use the data gathered to effectively 'prime' the theme of the upcoming meeting and potentially pitch the 'Lite Fundamentals' package.

Common Q&A

- What are the three specific quizzes outlined in the summary? Growth Fundamentals Online Quiz, What's Applicable Online Quiz, and HR Maths Online Quiz.
- What is the purpose of the "What's Applicable" quiz? To determine receptivity towards a software-based data review to see if administrative efficiencies can be achieved.
- What idea does the HR Maths quiz aim to introduce? The idea that the value of a role should be financially quantified before hiring a new team member.

- How are the quizzes characterized in the sales process? As a 'micro-step' between approach and meeting for the first time.
 - What platform hosts these online quizzes? Google Forms.
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Video Hyperlinks

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It allows them to consume concise, visual explanations of advisory concepts (like pricing or succession planning) on their own time.
- How it helps the advisor: It standardizes client communications, supports cold calling efforts, and provides immediate answers to common client questions.
- Who it may be suitable for: Clients needing pre-meeting education, or prospects requesting more information via email after a cold call.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Identify the concept you wish to convey (e.g., succession planning, margin vs markup, portal invitation).
2. Locate the appropriate hyperlink from the list of 8 options.
3. Right-click the mouse and select "Copy Link URL".
4. Paste the link into a direct email to the client, or load multiple links into your general email signature.
5. If you require content not on the list, contact your advisor-e coach to suggest new promotional material.

Common Q&A

- How many video hyperlinks are provided in this document? Eight (8) video hyperlinks are provided.
- Which video is recommended to support cold calling efforts? Video 8 ("customerdirect"), which explains the value of working with an advisor in the portal.
- What is the "pricingvsleakage" video designed to rebut? Instagram and Facebook advertisements that target tradies claiming 'cost plus' pricing is flawed.
- How does the document suggest utilizing the links on a daily basis? Loading the links as part of your email signature so clients can click them anytime.
- What video introduces the client to the Growth Curve? Video 6 ("curvestory").

Website Blurbs

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It clearly articulates the problems the firm solves, explains service options progressively, and builds trust through clear positioning.
- How it helps the advisor: It provides pre-written copy and structural logic (bands) to design a high-converting website before engaging a web developer.
- Who it may be suitable for: Accounting/Advisory firm owners looking to upgrade their website homepage and clearly define their service architecture.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Draft your website layout on a PowerPoint document using 'bands' (e.g., Band 1: Grab attention, Band 2: Clarify problem, Band 3: Position, Band 4: Reveal solution).
2. Select a copywriting style for the "Problem You Solve" section, such as 'Calling out the Ghosts', 'Metaphor Style', or 'Range Finder Style'.
3. Outline your services using an ascension model, defining clear packages like Basic Accounting, Growth Fundamentals, Good to Great, and Legacy.
4. Populate the service pages with provided descriptions for Tax Compliance, Bookkeeping, Business Set Up, Virtual CFO, etc.
5. Add visible "Calls to Action" and social proof (testimonials) so the prospect's next move is made easy within the first 10-30 seconds of browsing.

Common Q&A

- What should the first 'Band' of the website achieve? It should grab attention and assure the visitor they are on the correct website.
 - What are the three distinct engagement styles listed under Business Advisory? Education, Facilitation, and Advice.
 - What is the core message of the "Range Finder Style" blurb? Asking the question "How much is enough?" and helping clients test their specific dream.
 - How does the document define the purpose of forecasting in the Budgets section? It's not about trying to predict the future; it's about identifying 'probable scenarios' to plan for bargains or avoid over-trading.
 - What four packages are shown on the ascension diagram? Basic Accounting Package, Growth Fundamentals Package, Good to Great Package, and Legacy Package.
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client extadv consent

Benefits

- How it helps the business owner: It improves transparency and trust by securely granting their bank access to vital business intelligence, gathering "the very best minds" to support them.
- How it helps the advisor: It ensures strict compliance with the Privacy Act while facilitating collaborative advisory workflows with external centers of influence.
- Who it may be suitable for: Clients who are utilizing the portal's debt estimator tools and wish to share that live data directly with their banker.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step)

1. Discuss the intention of granting portal access to the banker with the client beforehand.
2. Send the template email to the client, explicitly listing the portal pages the banker will have access to (e.g., Covid 19 section, Loan Estimator, PDF Storage, Volatility Graph).
3. Reassure the client that access levels can be changed at any time if they feel their position is not enhanced.
4. Instruct the client to reply directly to the email to confirm their consent.
5. Save the reply for Privacy Act compliance records before granting the external login.

Common Q&A

- What is the primary reason stated for granting the banker portal access?

To improve transparency, trust, and to 'gather the very best minds' to help make the business more successful.

- Can the portal access be revoked or altered?

Yes, the access levels can be changed at any time in the future.

- Name three specific sections the banker will have access to according to the email.

Covid 19 Section, Exposure Dashboard (Loan Estimator), and the Volatility Graph (among others).

- Why is the client asked to reply to the email?

So the advisor has a copy of their consent for Privacy Act compliance.

- Who is the sender of this template email?

Bob the Accountant.

Seminar Delivery

These materials outline various educational team-building activities and professional presentation strategies aimed at improving leadership and mastering the art of professional public speaking.

The content in this section is better suited to senior and experienced advisors and is of an advanced nature.

30 to 40 Presentation Template

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Delivers a clear, engaging, and easy-to-follow presentation that doesn't overwhelm the audience.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Saves preparation time by utilizing a structured framework that sequences the presentation logically from opening to agenda.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Presenters, guest speakers, or facilitators tasked with delivering a concise, 30 to 40-minute educational session.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Define your Target Audience and Desired Outcomes at the top of your design summary.
2. Assign each presenter their specific slot using the Content / Why / Remember framework.
3. Draft your opening by establishing a "Connecting story" or preemptively "calling out the ghosts" to build rapport.
4. Formulate your "Why this" and "Why now" statements to justify the presentation's relevance.
5. Detail your Concept and rules of engagement (e.g., how to ask questions).
6. Break down your Content Design into three core Principles, providing three specific Details for each.
7. Transfer this structure into the Agenda Table/Run Sheet, plotting precise times for elements like "Meet & Greet", "Spkr 1", and "Morning tea" to ensure you stay within the 40-minute window.

Common Q&A:

- **What framework is used to structure the presenter's content?** The {Content / Why / Remember} framework.
- **How many details should support each Principle?** There is space provided for three details per Principle.
- **What does M.O.C stand for?** Master of Ceremonies.
- **What should you establish before revealing the agenda?** "How we roll" – setting the scene in terms of how to engage and ask questions.
- **What are you supposed to "call out" at the beginning of the presentation?** The "ghosts".

Blank Platform Template

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Ensures the audience understands the rules of the workshop and why the material is highly relevant to their survival or success.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a comprehensive "stage-by-stage" script outline that covers connecting, setting the scene, delivering, and closing without sounding arrogant or overly sales-driven.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Facilitators or advisors stepping onto a stage to run interactive, principle-based workshops.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Stage 1 (Connect):** Start strong using Universals (shared experiences) or Truisms (indisputable facts). Put yourself in "that moment" using a metaphorical story to build 'a theatre in their mind'.
2. **Stage 1 (Ghosts & Relevance):** Call out negative preemptive thoughts (ghosts). Then frame relevance by linking your concept to their key values: Survival, Security, Acceptance, Recognition, or Contribution (W.I.I.F.M).
3. **Stage 2 (Intro & Scene):** Keep your self-introduction under 1 minute. Set the scene by explaining this is an interactive workshop, introducing the 'park' board for off-topic questions, and encouraging participation.
4. **Stage 3 (Deliver):** Deliver principles using stories, visual aids, and humor. Force engagement by getting attendees to talk to each other to lift the emotional connection in the room.
5. **Stage 2 (Call to Action & Close):** Close the cycle by inviting attendees to a free 'discovery session'. Avoid heavy pitches so you don't slam their minds shut.

Common Q&A:

- **What are "Universals" and "Truisms"?** Universals are shared experiences everyone can relate to (e.g., traffic), while Truisms are indisputable facts verifiable in the here and now.
- **How long should a self-introduction be?** Keep it brief; any longer than 1 minute starts to sound egotistical.
- **How do you handle complex questions that derail the presentation?** Stick them on the 'park' board to come back to later.
- **What is the best way to judge the mood of the room?** By the audience's involvement with you and their ease of connecting with each other.
- **Should you end with a heavy sales pitch?** No, try to avoid heavy pitches; simply invite them to take advantage of a free discovery session.

Forecast presentation

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Shifts their mindset from viewing budgets as restrictive "diets" to using forecasts for strategic scenario planning and safe growth.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Demonstrates quantitative expertise by explaining bespoke revenue models and volatility reports, proving high value to the client.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients struggling with business limits, negative financial pass-fail mentalities, or a lack of logistical foundations in their numbers.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Open by addressing the "3 Reasons People Don't Use Cash Forecasts": the math is perceived as too hard, revenue is viewed as pass/fail, and budgets feel like restrictive diets.
2. Explain the difference between "Using Average vs Probability".
3. Present the "3 Things We Do Different": quantifying expectations via bespoke models, using Volatility reports to find probability ranges, and building action plans to test and measure.
4. Outline the "3 Advantages For Your Business": identifying the 'Profit Sweet-spot' to avoid over-trading, using Scenario Planning (Plans A, B & C), and knowing when to change direction to limit losses.

Common Q&A:

- **Why is budgeted spending often a negative experience?** It is viewed in the same way as a diet (restriction or 'going without').
- **How do we remove the pass-fail mentality?** By using Volatility reports to determine probability ranges instead of relying on averages.
- **What is the true purpose of the forecasts?** It's about how it helps grow or protect what has been built, not about predicting the future.
- **What does identifying the 'Profit Sweet-spot' help a business avoid?** It helps avoid over-trading (financial limits).
- **How is scenario planning described metaphorically?** "You catch a ball by anticipating where it will land, not by knowing from where it was thrown".

Funny Stories

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Increases audience attention and retention when communicating company messages or presentations.

- **How it helps the advisor:** Builds immediate rapport, breaks tension, and establishes the advisor as a confident, engaging speaker.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Speakers looking to inject humor and personality into their presentations or networking events.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Step 1:** Select a story you genuinely enjoy (personal experiences mixed with slight fiction, or standard/controversial topics handled absurdly).
2. **Step 2:** Ensure the audience can relate to the characters or topics.
3. **Step 3:** Start telling the story with a serious or innocent expression. Do not telegraph that a joke is coming.
4. **Step 4:** Take your time. Use pauses for dramatic effect and employ different voices to create 'theatre in their mind'.
5. **Step 5:** Project your voice with intonation. Be excited, calm down before a pause, then deliver the punch line.
6. **Step 6 & 7:** Practice in front of small audiences to test reactions, then perform when confident.

Common Q&A:

- **What did Mark Twain say about stories?** "There are several kinds of stories, but only one difficult kind - the humorous".
- **What happens if you don't appreciate the humor in your own story?** Your audience won't find it funny either.
- **Should you smile or laugh while leading up to the punchline?** No, you should keep a serious or innocent expression and tone.
- **How can you help the audience use their imagination?** Use pauses for dramatic effect, use different voices, and turn to face the character.
- **How should you pace your voice delivery?** Be excited at first, calm down a bit before you use a pause, and then come out with your punch line.

Growth Stage Seminar

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Provides a clear map of the business journey, allowing them to pinpoint where they are and what challenges are normal for their current stage.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Acts as a powerful diagnostic and seminar tool to sell targeted advisory services for specific growth stages (e.g., process improvement for Leverage, succession for Exit).

- **Who it may be suitable for:** Prospects or clients attending an educational seminar about scaling, business maturity, or exit planning.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Introduce the "Growth Fundamentals Framework" graphic, showing the journey from Launch to Exit/Decline, including the "Split point" and "Devil's Toilet".
2. Walk through early stages: Stage 1 Design (getting ready to leave your job) to Stage 3 Break-Even (covering costs).
3. Explain the mid-stages: Stage 5 Leverage (delegation/replication) and Stage 6 Reach (multiple locations/brand spread).
4. Detail the late stages: Stage 7 Leapfrog (acquisitions) and Stage 8 Maturity (commanding market share/governance).
5. Discuss Stage 9 Exit/Decline, showing the paths of succession/sale versus dwindling into retirement.
6. Conclude by explaining the 9 Growth Aspects (e.g., Governance, Innovation, Sales) that must be balanced at *every* stage.

Common Q&A:

- **What is the Growth Focus of Stage 2 (Launch)?** Growth through Enthusiasm & Creativity.
- **At what stage is a business sustaining the owner's lifestyle without them being 'hands-on' daily?** Stage 5. Leverage.
- **What is the Growth Focus of Stage 7 (Leapfrog)?** Growth through alliances & acquisition.
- **What are the two potential outcomes in Stage 9?** The owners realize their capital gain via sale/succession, OR the business dwindles as the owners seek retirement.
- **What is the purpose of the 9 Growth Aspects?** To ensure that at each level, the business objectives remain balanced and not overly consumed by the pursuit of growth.

MFS Drafting Template

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Ensures any message or core philosophy they wish to impart to their staff or clients is structured logically and emotionally.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a tangible worksheet to rapidly draft metaphor stories that naturally lead clients toward the advisor's specific service solutions.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Presenters preparing tailored stories to introduce complex or sensitive business concepts.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Define the foundational elements: Story Name, the 'Point' of the Story, the Problem/Opportunity it relates to, and the specific Service Solution you are leading to.
2. Draft "The Draw" by filling out three prompts: Capture (e.g., a guessing question), Describe (setting the scene), and Permission (advising the audience they might be shocked or amused).
3. Draft "The Plot" by listing your Story Anchors in logical/sequential order. Try to limit anchors to 5 or less.
4. Write "The Reveal" where you state the explicit Story Point (e.g., "Mental clarity is not enough...").
5. Draft "The Close" summarizing what you want to 'Stick'. Keep this limited to 3 points or less.

Common Q&A:

- What does the abbreviation 'MFS' stand for? Magic Formula Story.
 - What are the three components of 'The Draw'? Capture, Describe, and Permission.
 - How many anchors should you try to limit 'The Plot' to? 5 or less.
 - What should the Story Anchors provide? A sequence or logical order to the story.
 - How many points should you limit 'The Close' to? 3 or less.
-

Magic Formula Stories

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Helps them communicate culture, values, or corrective feedback to their team in a non-threatening, easily absorbed manner.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Allows the advisor to illustrate technical knowledge, empathy, and credibility without appearing boastful, lowering client resistance ("filters").
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Coaches and facilitators dealing with business culture, personal choice, or complex problem-solving.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Identify the purpose of your story: to Frame (provide context/parallel thinking), Connect (create 'theatre in their mind'), or Position (illustrate credibility without grandstanding).
2. Construct "The Draw": Capture attention via a shocking statement, open loop, or physical movement. Describe the setting, and provide permission for how the audience can engage.
3. Build "The Plot": Relate characters and motives using logical 'anchor statements'.
4. Execute "The Reveal": Facilitate the story to provide multiple meanings, or direct their thinking using metaphor.
5. Deliver "The Close": Bring it to a definitive end with impact, letting the 'king phrase' hang without adding fluffy explanations.

Common Q&A:

- **What is the benefit of using 'parallel thinking' in stories?** Edward De Bono suggests it is the most critical component in solving problems or developing innovative strategies.
 - **Why is storytelling a non-threatening way to present a concept?** It allows individuals to relate via 'theatre in their mind' and choose how much identification they show, providing safety parameters.
 - **Why is a story more palatable than grandstanding your qualifications?** Revealing attributes rather than promoting them allows the audience to be impressed with less chance of vulnerability, so they listen with fewer "filters".
 - **What should you do with the 'king phrase' in the Close?** Let it hang at the end rather than reducing its impact by context statements or fluffy explanation.
 - **If your 'king phrase' needs explaining, what went wrong?** You failed to relate the concept during the "PLOT" stage or the "REVEAL" was weak.
-

Paper Tower Model

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Provides a mathematical simulation showing how material costs, time efficiency, and quality (height) directly impact the bottom line.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Automates the complex scoring of the Paper Tower exercise, allowing the facilitator to focus on observing behavior rather than doing math.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Facilitators running the Paper Tower team-building and business simulation workshop.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Enter the "Cost" of materials used by tracking the number of sheets drawn. Each batch of 20 sheets costs \$2,000.
2. Track the "TIME (Taken in Minutes)". Calculate the profit/loss based on the time scale provided (0 to 10 minutes).
3. Measure the "Height" in mm. Apply the financial metrics where height adds to profit (e.g., 1200mm = \$1,000 profit) or triggers penalties/bonuses (under 300mm = loss of \$6000; over 2400mm = \$10,000 bonus).
4. Combine these three metrics to finalize the total Profit or Loss.

Common Q&A:

- **How much does one batch of 20 sheets cost?** \$2,000.
- **What is the financial penalty if the tower is under 300 mm?** A loss of \$6000.

- What happens if a team builds a tower over 2400 mm? They receive an additional bonus of \$10,000.
 - Does time taken affect the profit? Yes, time taken in minutes corresponds to varying scales of profit or loss.
 - What is the initial material cost for 100 sheets? \$10,000.
-

Paper Tower Review Questions

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Translates a fun game into profound insights about workplace process, outcome-orientation vs. process-driven behavior, and team personalities.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a scripted, psychological debrief method that smoothly transitions a group from playing a game to adopting a formal 9-step business consulting process.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Consultants reviewing the aftermath of the Paper Tower exercise.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Have teams calculate their Profit/Loss based on minutes taken, value of materials, and height achieved.
2. Ask initial review questions: "Did you have fun?", "Did you make a profit?", "Where did you go wrong?".
3. Provide specific feedback using exact times (e.g., "At 2.42 into the exercise, Jim said...") and ask about team effectiveness and personalities.
4. Introduce the 9-step process: Appoint Chairperson, Appoint Timekeeper, Determine Objective (SMART), Apportion Time, Brainstorm without assessment, Assess options, Eliminate/Select, Allocate Resource, Prepare/Implement Action Plan.
5. Facilitate a discussion to brainstorm workplace applications for this process and assign an "enforcer".

Common Q&A:

- **What is the formula for calculating profit value?** Number of minutes taken + Value of material used + Value of height achieved = Profit/Loss.
- **How should a facilitator read back observations?** List things seen and heard with the exact time at which they were observed.
- **What are two common areas of failure for teams in this exercise?** Failing to examine all options (poor brainstorming) and inaccurately defining the objective.

- **What does the acronym S.M.A.R.T stand for regarding objectives?** Specific, Measurable, Agreed, Revisable and Time bound.
 - **What rule applies during the brainstorming phase?** Strictly no assessment of ideas; avoid language that runs down the idea.
-

Paper Tower Task Sheet

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Forces teams to operate under strict constraints of time, material, and rules, mirroring real-world project pressures.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Lays out clear, indisputable rules for the exercise, preventing arguments and ensuring a uniform challenge.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Participants acting as the "building team" during the Paper Tower workshop.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Hand out the task sheet and explain the objective: build a tower profitably based on materials, height, and time.
2. Set the timer: Allow exactly 20 minutes for preparation/planning.
3. Issue an initial 100 sheets. Allow teams to draw up to 500 sheets total in batches of 20.
4. Enforce constraints: Unused drawn materials count toward the cost. No prefabrication allowed (sheets must be flat at construction start). Only provided materials can be used.
5. Set the build timer for a maximum of 10 minutes.
6. Ensure the tower is self-supporting and remains intact for at least 1 minute after completion before measuring height.

Common Q&A:

- **How long is the preparation phase?** 20 minutes.
 - **How long is the building phase?** A maximum of 10 minutes.
 - **Can teams pre-fold or prefabricate paper during the prep phase for the final build?** No, prefabrication is not allowed, paper must be flat when building begins.
 - **Do unused sheets count towards the total cost?** Yes, once drawn, they count towards the total whether used or not.
 - **How long must the tower stand upright to qualify?** It must remain intact and upright for at least one minute after completion.
-

Powerful Seminars

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Creates highly professional, targeted marketing events that position their business favorably and drive client acquisition.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a complete end-to-end blueprint encompassing content design, audience psychology, 6-week marketing timelines, delivery styles, and AV logistics.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Business owners, advisors, or marketing managers designing and hosting public speaking events or workshops.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Design:** Identify the target audience, define outcomes, and build content using the C.P.D hierarchy (Concept, Principles, Detail). Ensure content relates to Pragmatists, Reflectors, Theorists, and Activists.
2. **Plan:** Follow the detailed 6-week timeline (sending invitations, confirming RSVPs, running rehearsals, sorting handouts).
3. **Delivery Style:** Choose the appropriate style (Educator, Motivator, Coach, Collegiate) based on whether you are Coaching, Presenting, or Facilitating.
4. **Execute Delivery:** Prepare psychologically. Connect with the audience via universals/ghosts. Use Honey & Mumford relevance statements. Describe the theme, introduce yourself, set the scene, layout the agenda, and go to work!.
5. **Logistics:** Test all light and sound equipment beforehand. Check mic directionality and ensure overhead lights don't blind the audience.

Common Q&A:

- **What is the Public Speaking Objective?** To position the speaker favorably in the mind of the audience so they seek strategic services.
- **What is the C.P.D hierarchy?** Concept – Principle – Detail.
- **How do you tailor information for "Reflectors"?** Give them time to 'think it over' and direct them to write down their thoughts.
- **What delivery style features a rapid verbal pace and frequent calls to action?** The Motivator style.
- **How should you hold a hand-held microphone?** At about 'sternum level', ensuring your body moves with your head if it is unidirectional.

Seminar & Entertainment

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Prevents staff from embarrassing the company at functions, ensuring they build professional relationships without coming across as insincere or pushing unwanted sales pitches.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Offers strict protocols for navigating social settings, maintaining integrity on expense accounts, and successfully gathering leads.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Professionals attending trade shows, corporate dinners, or networking seminars.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Adopt the mindset that it is work, not a free booze-up. Do not overestimate the level of relationship with current clients.
2. Approach with a smile, eye contact, and offer a handshake (waiting 2-3 seconds for a response). Use prepared open-ended one-liners.
3. Work the room: be a "comfortable butterfly," not an "anchor in the corner." Rotate to meet everyone.
4. When joining a group, check body positions and ask permission ("hey guys, would it be o-k if I asked those people over...") to prevent invoking exclusionary tribal instincts.
5. Offer hospitality, keep things safe, and always stay "one drink behind" the client.
6. If a client tries to buy, avoid "Selling out of bounds" by steering the conversation to a future Monday call.
7. Get into 'state' before the event by visualizing a confident posture and voice tone.

Common Q&A:

- **Why is it easier to develop business relationships in social settings?** It removes the façade people establish, making it more comfortable to inquire about personal backgrounds.
- **How should you handle introducing yourself if no name tags are present?** Make eye contact, provide both your first and surname, and say nothing for 2-3 seconds until they respond.
- **What is the "anchor in the corner" mistake?** Planting yourself in one spot with one client instead of rotating around the room to meet everyone.
- **What rule should you follow regarding alcohol at a work function?** Always stay one drink behind your client.
- **Why shouldn't you "sell out of bounds" when entertaining?** You can't control the environment, it makes hospitality seem insincere, and alcohol could lead to buyer's remorse.

Spaghetti Tower Task Sheet

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** A rapid, low-cost team-building exercise that quickly highlights team communication and planning flaws under pressure.
- **How it helps the advisor:** An easily scalable ice-breaker or problem-solving simulation that requires minimal material setup.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Facilitators needing a short, 30-minute team challenge.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Hand out the task sheet and explain the goal: Build a tower taller than the competitors.
2. Issue exact resources: 20 sticks of uncooked spaghetti, 1 roll tape, 1m string, 2 marshmallows.
3. Start a 20-minute timer for preparation. Allow testing, but strictly forbid prefabrication (components must be flat when building starts).
4. Start a 10-minute timer for construction.
5. Enforce the final rules: The tower must be self-supporting, hold 1 complete marshmallow at the top, and remain intact for 1 minute before measuring height from the surface.

Common Q&A:

- **What is the total time allocated for the Spaghetti Tower task?** 30 minutes (20 mins prep, 10 mins build).
 - **What resources are allowed?** 20 sticks of spaghetti, tape, 1m of string, and 2 marshmallows.
 - **Is prefabrication allowed during the preparation phase?** No, components must be laid flat on the table before construction begins.
 - **What must the tower support at its highest point?** 1 complete Marshmallow.
 - **When does timing for the 1-minute intact rule begin?** Immediately after the 10 mins of allocated construction time.
-

Team Problem Solving

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Prevents teams from jumping straight to solutions and suffering analysis paralysis, ensuring complex challenges are solved methodically.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides an authoritative, 9-step framework supported by institutional research to guide client strategy sessions and ensure accountability via an "Enforcer".

- **Who it may be suitable for:** Facilitators and management teams navigating the transition from problem identification to execution.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Appoint a Chairperson, Timekeeper, and Scribe.
2. Determine the Objective in writing using the S.M.A.R.T format (ensure it states *why* achievement is critical).
3. Apportion time to each stage to prevent analysis paralysis.
4. Brainstorm without assessment: Enforce strict separation of judgment and use mind mapping to foster divergent thinking.
5. Assess options and apply critical filters.
6. Eliminate and Select the best option using tools like the Impact vs. Effort Matrix.
7. Allocate resources (budget, team, time).
8. Prepare an Action Plan and assign an Enforcer to manage the implementation loop.

Common Q&A:

- **What usually undermines team problem solving?** A lack of structure rather than a lack of talent, and jumping straight to solutions without a shared understanding.
- **What is the most frequent point of failure in team exercises?** The premature assessment of ideas during brainstorming.
- **What tool is useful during the 'Eliminate and Select' stage?** The Impact vs. Effort Matrix.
- **Why is the 'Allocate Resource' step critical?** Because a solution without a budget, a dedicated team, or scheduled time is merely a wish.
- **What is the role of the Enforcer?** An individual who takes psychological and operational ownership of the outcome to ensure momentum doesn't dissipate.

Team Workshop Run Sheet

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Keeps the entire team aligned on the schedule, ensuring long days remain productive and strictly timed.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Provides a plug-and-play matrix to manage the logistics, content, purpose, and required resources for a full two-day workshop.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Seminar coordinators and facilitators managing multi-day training events.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Fill out the Run Sheet for Day 1 and Day 2, utilizing the provided table columns.
2. Allocate exact "Session Time (mins)" for each block.

3. Set strict "Start" and "Finish" times (e.g., Session 1 from 8:30 AM to 10:00 AM).
4. Detail the "Content", "Purpose", and "Resource Required" for each specific block to keep presenters prepared.
5. Ensure appropriate breaks (e.g., 20 mins morning, 45 mins lunch) and mandatory Management Reviews (10 mins) are scheduled between main sessions.
6. Conclude each day with a 30-minute "Day Review".

Common Q&A:

- **How long are the primary workshop sessions?** 90 minutes each.
 - **What happens between Session 2 and the lunch break?** A 10-minute Management Review.
 - **How long is the lunch break scheduled for on Day 1?** 45 minutes (12:00 PM to 12:45 PM).
 - **What activity concludes both Day 1 and Day 2?** A 30-minute Day Review.
 - **What time does the Day 2 overview start?** 9:00 AM.
-

Feedback form

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** Allows them to quantitatively judge whether a seminar delivered ROI and if their staff found the content relevant.
- **How it helps the advisor:** Serves as a critical lead-generation and quality-control tool to gauge presenter flow, story effectiveness, and secure future attendances.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Attendees filling out feedback at the conclusion of a seminar or workshop.

How to use the material in practice:

1. Distribute the form to attendees at the end of the presentation.
2. Ask attendees to evaluate if the content was relevant to their business.
3. Ask attendees to assess instructional methods (e.g., did stories make content easier to relate to?).
4. Ask for constructive criticism on content that did not appeal and whether the presenters felt mismatched.
5. Gather operational feedback on the environment/atmosphere, and secure a "yes/no" lead on whether they would attend a future seminar.

Common Q&A:

- **What does the form ask regarding the use of stories?** "Did the use of stories make the content easier to relate to for you?".

- **How does the form address multi-speaker events?** It asks, "Do you feel the content flowed between presenters or do you feel the presentation was mismatched?".
- **Does the form measure technical expectations?** Yes, it asks if the presentation delivered content of a technical nature such that it met expectations.
- **What logistical aspects does the feedback cover?** The overall style, environment, and atmosphere.
- **How does the form generate future leads?** By asking, "would you consider attending a ABC Firm's seminar in future?".

Positioning

These materials offer a comprehensive guide for professional advisors to transition from transactional service providers to trusted authorities. A core focus is placed on positioning, which emphasizes selling one's personal identity and values rather than just a specific product to build congruence and trust.

The content in this section is better suited to senior advisors that are focused on fee growth and is of an intermediate nature.

1. The Three Engagement Types

Benefits: This template clarifies the nature of your client relationship by categorizing work into Advice, Facilitation, or Education. It ensures that engagements are driven by the desire to do the job properly and achieve better client outcomes, rather than just up-selling.

How it helps the business owner: It provides clear expectations. Depending on their needs, the client receives distinct value: acceptance of advice for clear consequences, handling of a trigger event with global and local relevance, or sequential comprehension to close a knowledge gap.

How it helps the advisor: It defines the advisor's position (e.g., Hierarchical for Advice, Professionally Detached for Facilitation) and delivery imperative. It also encourages advisors to "Look Both Ways" (pre-event causes and post-event effects) to extend the engagement arena naturally.

Suitable for: Clients experiencing specific trigger events (like loan drawdowns), knowledge gaps, or situations requiring direct advice.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Identify the Driver:** Determine if the client is facing a clear consequence, a trigger event, or a knowledge gap.
2. **Determine the Engagement Type:** Categorize the work as Advice, Facilitation, or Education.
3. **Look Both Ways:** Examine the "cause/pre" (e.g., feasibility of a loan) and "effect/post" (e.g., management meetings post-drawdown) of the client's event.
4. **Deliver on the Imperative:** Execute the work prioritizing accuracy (for advice), the 'reveal' (for facilitation), or chunking (for education).

2. Capacity, Capability, Opportunity (CCO)

Benefits: CCO provides a structured lens to evaluate how a business can realistically grow.

How it helps the business owner: It clearly separates the legitimate constraints of their business (capacity) from their skill and financial limitations (capability), and ensures they aren't ignoring market realities (opportunity).

How it helps the advisor: It can be used as an internal diagnostic tool to find areas to add value, or as a formal agenda structure to guide a client discussion. It acts as a perfect entry point to tease service offerings without solving all the client's problems on the spot.

Suitable for: Businesses aiming to scale, increase transaction volumes, or move into new premium markets.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Frame the Discussion:** Introduce the framework formally as an agenda item, or internally assess the client's status.
2. **Assess Capacity:** Evaluate if they can physically produce more or handle higher transactional volume (e.g., checking downtime or machinery limits).
3. **Assess Capability:** Evaluate if they have the skills, personnel depth, and financial resources/funding to support the growth.
4. **Assess Opportunity:** Look for proof of strong market demand from existing or new clients before proceeding.

3. The Helicopter Story

Benefits: This framework uses a powerful visual analogy to dismantle the flawed logic of "once a year" accounting meetings.

How it helps the business owner: It helps them visualize their business (the helicopter) navigating a volatile economy (wavy ground and storms). It reveals how dangerous it is to fly "blindfolded" without accurate, timely internal dashboards.

How it helps the advisor: It perfectly positions the advisor as the essential "Air Control Tower". By highlighting the risks of high-impact events or internal fraud (3-ton loads), it allows the advisor to naturally ask for more frequent strategic meetings.

Suitable for: Clients who view accounting as an annual compliance exercise and resist regular advisory check-ins.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Draw the Scene:** Illustrate a wavy ground (representing high frequency/low impact seasonal volatility) and a mountain (high impact events).
2. **Introduce the Helicopter:** Explain that the helicopter is the business, the pilot is the owner, and the dashboard is their internal reporting.
3. **Apply the Blindfold:** Show how inaccurate or untimely data puts a blindfold on the pilot.
4. **Position the Control Tower:** Draw the control tower (the advisor) and ask, "What use is the control tower if the pilot only calls once a year?".
5. **Secure the Meeting:** Ask the client how often they feel they should meet to discuss their strategic flight plan.

4. Mastering Positioning

Benefits: This template teaches how to move from being a transactional "vendor of hours" to a collaborative "trusted authority".

How it helps the business owner: It creates a safe, trusted environment where their biological survival mechanisms are not triggered. They can relax, knowing their advisor is authentic and on their side.

How it helps the advisor: It shifts the focus from selling a specific product to "selling yourself". By achieving total congruence, it removes friction from the advisory process, making influence much easier.

Suitable for: All prospect and client interactions, especially initial meetings where trust and authority are still being established.

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Focus on the Client's Mind:** Set your strategic intent to occupy a space of trust and authority before you ever open a spreadsheet.

2. **Align Your Delivery (Congruence):** Ensure your technical advice perfectly matches your body language, tone of voice, and fundamental values.
 3. **Monitor the Vibe:** Be aware that a poor vibe can trigger the client's chemical survival response (norepinephrine), making them skeptical and defensive.
 4. **Establish the Somatic Connection:** Aim for the unspoken feeling of alignment so the client relaxes and true collaborative influence begins.
-

Common Q&A

1. Q: Does the CCO framework need to be formally presented to the client every time?

A: No, CCO can be used externally to frame an agenda, but it is equally effective as an internal framework you use to assess a business and find areas where you can add value.

2. Q: Should I use the Helicopter Story to sell additional financial products?

A: No, the Helicopter Story is about securing regular strategic meetings to review the client's "flight plan" and foresee potential problems, moving away from a flawed once-a-year mentality.

3. Q: How does "Positioning" differ from a standard sales pitch?

A: A sales pitch focuses on what you do (the service). Positioning is about who you are in the mind of the client; it is the selling of yourself based on trust, authority, and alignment.

4. Q: What happens if my advice is logically sound, but my positioning is incongruent?

A: Trust is biological. If your tone or body language triggers a survival response (a poor vibe), the client will become defensive and risk-averse; the logic of your advice won't matter.

5. Q: How can I naturally expand an engagement without making the client feel "up-sold"?

A: By using the "Look Both Ways" approach. When a client approaches you with an event (like a loan), you naturally examine the pre-event causes (feasibility) and post-event effects (management meetings) to ensure better client outcomes.

6. Q: What does 'Capacity' actually mean in the CCO framework?

A: Capacity strictly refers to the business's ability for transactional volume. This means evaluating if they have the physical room, machinery, or non-bottlenecked team availability to scale up.

Learning to Sell

This section details a comprehensive advisory framework designed to help consultants align their sales and delivery methods with a client's specific level of business complexity. The material contrasts campaign-based selling, which offers pre-packaged modules for simpler needs, with total needs selling, a bespoke approach for intricate, high-value engagements. A central decision tree guides advisors through selecting the right path based on their own confidence levels and the prospect's receptiveness.

The content in this section is better suited to senior advisors that are focused on fee growth and is of an intermediate nature.

Section 1: Detailed Breakdown of Core Templates

1. The Introduction Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** Provides a scripted, logical progression for the crucial first meeting, moving smoothly from building rapport ("Foreplay") to setting clear expectations. It uses an "Event, Cause & Effect" storytelling model to build credibility and establish empathy without feeling interrogative.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It structures the conversation so the advisor maintains control. By using "Check Time" and "Ask Permission" scripts, the advisor can naturally transition into business talk while ensuring they have the floor to explain their approach uninterrupted.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It reduces anxiety by explicitly defining the meeting objective and making the decision-making process visible. The owner knows exactly what will happen next, which removes the tension of a high-pressure sales pitch.
- **Suitable for:** Initial discovery sessions and early-stage prospect meetings where trust foundations and mutual alignment need to be established.

2. The Lite Sales Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** This template uses a specific, modular "Campaign" approach built around a structured sequence using the acronym **S.P.I.D.E.R:** **Show** your get out of jail card, **Pin** the tail on the donkey (Growth Curve), **Investigate** blockages, **Determine/Dangle** the prize (Revenue Model), **Ensure** conditions are agreed, and **Reveal** the golden key.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It simplifies the sales process into manageable steps and introduces predefined boundaries (e.g., requiring the client to commit time, take action, and agree to a monthly fee) before the final solution is revealed.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It provides visual context for their business struggles by placing them on a "Growth Curve" and clearly outlines the financial potential of fixing their constraints through the "Revenue Model".
- **Suitable for:** Smaller, less complex business circumstances where the advisor is offering a pre-packaged program (Modular Delivery) typically requiring 1-2 hours to complete the sale.

3. The Scoping Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** This template establishes the framework for a deep-dive, fact-finding mission that explores the internal drivers of the business without the immediate pressure of proposing solutions.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It explicitly separates the "discovery" phase from the "solution" phase. It also provides a structured way to give a rough price estimate ("between \$x and \$y") to qualify the prospect's budget early on without committing to a hard quote.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It reassures the client through privacy statements and establishes that the session is about challenging their thinking and understanding their unique issues, not just filling out a survey.
- **Suitable for:** Complex engagements or bespoke "Total Needs" selling, where understanding the specific nuances of the client's operations is mandatory before presenting a proposal.

4. The Presentation Prompts

- **Core Benefits:** Focuses on the "Reveal" stage, giving advisors a structured method to present their service offer while systematically neutralizing objections.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It utilizes the strategy of "Calling out the ghosts" by proactively identifying and parking potential concerns (like price or delivery issues) before they disrupt the presentation. It also guides the advisor to use "Trial Closing" to test the prospect's receptiveness throughout the meeting.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** The transparent approach reduces the emotional charge of negotiations. By agreeing that neither party has to commit to an unworkable deal, the client feels respected and safe to voice their true thoughts.
- **Suitable for:** The pivotal meeting where the tailored solution or formal proposal is presented, leading up to the final implementation decision.

5. The Implementation Rationale

- **Core Benefits:** Designed to manage the final negotiation stages, focusing heavily on bridging the "Emotional Intensity Gap"—the difference between expectations and reality.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It trains the advisor to establish firm negotiation boundaries by differentiating between "must have" and "nice to have" terms (e.g., must have \$10,000, like to have it paid upfront). It encourages detachment from the outcome so the advisor remains objective.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** By handling objections as legitimate feedback rather than arguments to be won, the client is invited to co-solve problems. This ensures they aren't pressured into a "shoe-horned" deal.
- **Suitable for:** Final-stage closing meetings where the goal is to finalize contracts, define boundaries, and handle any lingering objections to secure a win-win agreement.

6. The Decision Tree & Sales Structure

- **Core Benefits:** This acts as the strategic brain behind the operation, providing a flowchart to determine the best sales approach (Modular/Campaign vs. Bespoke/Total Needs) based on the client's sophistication and the advisor's confidence.
 - **How it helps the Advisor:** It removes the guesswork. If an advisor is new, the tree directs them to "Free Client Content" for a softer experience. If dealing with a targeted prospect who fits a smaller business profile, it routes them to the "Lite Fundamentals" process.
 - **How it helps the Business Owner:** It ensures the sales approach aligns with their specific processing style—whether they are an Activist who wants quick action, a Pragmatist seeking proof, a Reflector needing time, or a Theorist wanting to contribute.
 - **Suitable for:** Advisors in the planning phase, deciding how to categorize leads and which presentation/scoping pathway will yield the highest success rate.
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Section 2: Step-by-Step Practical Application

Here is a practical method for deploying this material with a new prospect:

- **Step 1: Preparation & Triage (Using the Decision Tree).** Before contacting the prospect, use the Decision Tree to evaluate their business profile. Decide if you are launching a pre-packaged "Campaign" (for smaller, lower-fee clients) or a bespoke "Total Needs" process (for larger, complex clients). Identify the prospect's likely learning style to tailor your communication.
- **Step 2: The Introduction Meeting.** Open the meeting using the "Foreplay" script to build rapport, then "Check Time" to establish a professional boundary. State your meeting objective clearly, share a relevant "Common Problem" story to build empathy, and confirm if they are open to a more detailed scoping session.
- **Step 3: Scoping or Lite Sales.**
 - *If using the Lite Sales Track (Campaign):* Follow the SPIDER acronym. Show your "get out of jail card," map their position on the Growth Curve, investigate their constraints, dangle the Revenue Model, set your three conditions for working together, and reveal the program.
 - *If using Bespoke Scoping:* Schedule 1.5 hours. Establish that you are there to challenge their thinking, not provide immediate solutions. Guide them through the fact-find and provide a rough budget estimate at the end.
- **Step 4: The Presentation.** When returning with a proposal, set the scene by confirming nothing has changed in their business since you last spoke. Immediately "Call out the ghosts" to neutralize known objections. Use trial closing ("How does this look/feel/sound?") as you reveal the offer.

- **Step 5: Implementation & Negotiation.** Enter the final meeting knowing your "must have" boundaries. If caught with an unexpected objection, recognize its importance objectively ("On a scale of 1-10, how critical is this issue?") and invite the client to help solve the difference rather than defending your position.
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Section 3: Common Q&A

1. What is the difference between "Campaign Selling" and "Total Needs Selling"?

Campaign selling involves approaching clients with a pre-packaged, modular solution to a common issue, making it faster to deliver but with a risk of missing nuanced problems. Total Needs selling is an explorative, bespoke process void of solution bias, which takes more time and confidence but addresses complex problems and yields larger fees.

2. Where should a new or less confident advisor start in this framework?

New advisors should start with the "Free Client Content" section. This provides a softer experience because it does not end with a specific offer, removing the feeling of being pressured or "channelled" and setting the stage for future discussions.

3. How should I handle a client who constantly brings up objections during the final presentation?

The most effective strategy is to proactively "Call out the ghosts" by naming the likely objections at the beginning of the presentation to remove the emotional tension. If an unexpected objection arises, clarify its importance, state your reply without judgment, and ask the client how they believe both parties could "get around this issue".

4. How do I adapt my sales approach to different client personalities?

You should design a sales process that considers the four Processing Styles (Honey & Mumford). For instance, give *Reflectors* the time they need to withdraw and think, provide *Pragmatists* with proof and data, explain the sequence of action to impulsive *Activists*, and allow *Theorists* to voice their ideas on the solution.

5. Why is the "Emotional Intensity Gap" important during negotiations?

Emotions are driven by our expectations and the variation between those expectations and reality. Managing client expectations proactively ensures that you facilitate a logical win-win agreement rather than dealing with the negative experience of a mismatched reality.

6. What should I do if a prospect simply isn't a good fit or we can't agree on terms?

You must mentally define your "walk away price" and negotiation boundaries beforehand. Maintain your perspective and emotional detachment; it is perfectly acceptable to decline unprofitable business. You should excuse yourself tactfully, leaving the door open to check back in 6 to 12 months.

Pricing & Proposals

This tutorial provides a comprehensive guide on utilizing pricing models and proposal templates specifically designed for advisory services. To access these professional tools for client use, users must navigate to the business entities section within advisor mode. The system includes a pricing matrix where consultants input team rates to automatically calculate costs for tasks like scoping, research, and implementation. When drafting the final advisory proposal, it is essential to highlight the client's time commitment alongside the financial investment to ensure mutual accountability. Additionally, the platform offers specialized light fundamentals documents that use automated tables to streamline the creation of service agreements.

The content in this section is better suited to senior advisors that are focused on fee growth and is of an intermediate nature.

1. Advisory Pricing Model (Spreadsheet)

- **Benefits:** This comprehensive model removes the guesswork from pricing by providing pre-calculated bundled options, content suggestions, and a "Blank Team" matrix. It breaks down complex jobs into manageable components (e.g., scoping, research, presentation, implementation) and allows you to easily calculate fees based on the specific team members assigned to each task. It also includes a highly detailed Due Diligence Scoping Model for mergers or acquisitions.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Provides complete transparency regarding what they are paying for. When you present pricing based on this model, the owner clearly sees the breakdown of tasks, timelines, and the specific objectives of the work being performed.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Protects the firm's profitability. By inputting specific hourly rates for travel, preparation, and advisory time across different team members, the advisor ensures that every hour is accounted for. It prevents scope creep and allows the advisor to clearly distinguish between chargeable discovery/scoping work and non-chargeable proposal presentation time.
- **Who it is suitable for:** Best suited for firms utilizing multiple team members on a single project, and for complex, bespoke advisory engagements—especially due diligence or structural reviews.

2. General Advisory Proposal (Slide Deck)

- **Benefits:** A structured framework designed to convert the findings of a discovery meeting into a compelling, logical pitch. It visually connects the client's "End Game" to the specific actions required to get there.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It explicitly focuses on *their* stated objectives and what is currently holding them back (Legitimate Constraints). Importantly, it outlines exactly how many hours of the *client's* time (or their staff's time) will be required to execute the recommendations, setting clear expectations from day one.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It provides a professional, easy-to-follow narrative structure that justifies the requested financial investment. It also features a built-in "Variation to Scope of Works" template to handle future out-of-scope requests.
- **Who it is suitable for:** Ideal for clients requiring bespoke, customized consulting tailored to their specific, unique business problems.

3. Lite Fundamentals Proposal (Slide Deck)

- **Benefits:** This template offers a pre-campaigned, "out-of-the-box" advisory program. It divides the advisory journey into three highly digestible pillars: Getting More Organised, Getting More Work, and Doing More Profitable Work.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It demystifies business growth by providing a clear, educational curriculum. Owners learn fundamentals like the working capital cycle, the 4 levels of consumer awareness, and process improvement cycles.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It is highly scalable and efficient. The proposal uses a merge table, meaning the advisor can quickly input data to auto-populate the document rather than writing it from scratch.
- **Who it is suitable for:** Best for smaller businesses or clients who need foundational business coaching and structured systems rather than highly complex, customized interventions.

Practical Application: Step-by-Step Method

Step 1: Conduct Discovery & Scoping Begin by holding a discovery session to understand the client's needs. If the needs are complex (e.g., a formal risk management review or a merger), use

the **Advisory Pricing Model** to flush out the tasks required. Use the "Blank Team Pricing Matrix" to input your staff's names and their respective travel, prep, and advisory rates.

Step 2: Allocate Time and Calculate Fees Within the pricing model, break the project into components (Introduction, Scoping, Research, Presentation, Implementation, Review). Assign the appropriate team member to each task and allocate the hours. Keep in mind that while discovery and research might be chargeable, the proposal presentation itself is generally not.

Step 3: Select and Draft the Proposal

- If the engagement is highly customized, open the **General Advisory Proposal**. List the client's Business Objectives and Constraints. In the "Recommendations" section, detail the steps to win and *crucially*, list the hours the client must commit to the process.
- If the client simply needs foundational help, open the **Lite Fundamentals Proposal**. Navigate to the merge table in the portal and enter the required data to automatically populate the proposal's fields.

Step 4: Present and Manage the Engagement Present the proposal, clearly outlining the monthly investment and the total fee. Once signed, if the client later requests assistance with an unquoted issue (like financing new equipment), immediately use the **Variation to Scope of Works** document included at the end of the templates. Document the new issue, the timeline, and the extra estimated fee (e.g., 14 hours for \$3,700) and have them sign it before commencing the extra work.

Common Q&A

Q1: Where do I input my firm's specific hourly rates?

A: You must enter your staff names and their varying rates (travel, prep, advisory) into the "Blank Team Pricing Matrix" tab of the Advisory Pricing Model before using the calculation sheets.

Q2: Should I charge the client for the time it takes to present the proposal?

A: Generally, the presentation is not charged to the client. However, depending on the complexity, you may charge for the scoping, discovery, and research analysis phases that lead up to the proposal.

Q3: In the General Advisory Proposal's "Recommendations" section, whose hours are supposed to be listed?

A: The hours listed there are strictly for the *client* or their staff. It is designed to show them how much of their own time they must commit to make the project a success.

Q4: How do I easily fill out the Lite Fundamentals Proposal?

A: The Lite Fundamentals Proposal is driven by a merge table tool in the advisor portal. You enter the data into the tool, and it automatically inserts the values into the document.

Q5: What do I do if a client asks for extra work after the original proposal is signed?

A: Both proposal templates include a "Variation to Scope of Works" document. You should use this to formally outline the newly identified opportunity, the timeline, and the additional estimated fee required before beginning the work.